



# Courier Industries: Opportunities For Electronics

Smart logistics refers to the realisation of system perception, comprehensive analysis and processing in various kinds of logistics, including storage and distribution



(Credit: <https://medium.com>)



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**E**lectronic devices are increasingly being seen in the field of courier industry for packaging, sorting and delivering. Electronics and electro-mechanical equipment used for delivery services have become indispensable for better service of customers not only in cities but also in remote areas. Service quality of the courier industry is often judged by the state of equipment they have at their service.

Package or parcel delivery is the delivery of shipping containers, parcels or high-volume mail as a single shipment. The service is provided by most postal systems, express mailers, private courier companies and truck-load shipping couriers.

## Improved experiments in the postal department

The government of India's Department of Posts improved its Mail Processing Centre at New Delhi in August 2012 by setting up an automated system that enables processing of up to 55,000 mail pieces (approximately 35,000 letters and 20,000 mixed mail packages) per hour. This automated mail pro-

cessing system was installed by Siemens. The system consists of a sorting machine with an integrated reading and video coding machine, which reads barcodes or manually-written addresses on letters line-by-line. Based on addresses, the sorting machine automatically sorts the letters and collects them in a specified bin in a single turn.

This new automation technology enables India Post to significantly reduce processing time, improve productivity and deliver high-quality service. Globally, Siemens has installed more than 22,100 such systems for letter, parcel and courier express parcel services in more than forty countries.

Multiple optical character readers (OCRs) can read the entire address of an envelope, spray a barcode on it and sort it at the rate of more than nine per second. Wide-area barcode readers can read a barcode virtually anywhere on the letter. The remote barcoding system provides barcoding for handwritten script mails or mails that cannot be read by OCRs.

An electronics system, when added to a customised mailbox, adds several benefits. Simple electronics, such as displays, keyboards, barcode readers and transmitters/receivers, may be added to a mailbox, which can make mail delivery more efficient.

## The magic of drones

Drones can be effectively used in mail delivery systems. There are many elderly people whose mobility is limited. Drones can be used effectively to deliver mail and parcels to such people.

Drone tech for delivering parcels and other types of goods is receiving massive investments from big players all over the globe. With such large companies as Amazon, Walmart, UPS, Google and global postal companies investing in drone delivery projects, it is only a matter of time before wide-scale drone delivery becomes a reality.